

While Shepherds Watched Their Flocks

- 1 While shepherds watched their flocks by night,
all seated on the ground,
the angel of the Lord came down,
and glory shone around,
and glory shone around.
- 2 “Fear not,” said he — for mighty dread
had seized their troubled mind —
“glad tidings of great joy I bring
to you and all mankind,
to you and all mankind.
- 3 “To you, in David’s town this day,
is born of David’s line,
the Savior, who is Christ the Lord,
and this shall be the sign,
and this shall be the sign:
- 4 “The heav’nly babe you there shall find
to human view displayed,
all meanly wrapped in swathing bands,
and in a manger laid,
and in a manger laid.
- 5 “All glory be to God on high,
and to the earth be peace;
goodwill henceforth, from heav’n to men,
begin and never cease,
begin and never cease!”

Words: Nahum Tate, 1700 (Luke 2:8-16)

Music: Harmonia Sacra, 1812; arr. from George Frederick Handel, 1728

Tune: CHRISTMAS · 8.6.8.6.6 · Scripture: Luke 2:8

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